

Blink — playtest sheet

RULES V0.23 · ONE SHEET PER GAME

players ____ date _____
start _____ end _____

Play the base game only. No objectives module, no expansions — those are not tuned for these rules. The five questions below are the ones the design is actually stuck on; everything else can wait for the feedback form.

① **Free moves — the big unknown**

Each turn your band gives you 1–4 free moves (land across your own units, or sea). Tick roughly how many you actually used, and say what for.

moves used per turn, typically	none	1	2	3	4	wanted more
mostly used to...	reinforce	escape	claim ground	didn't bother		
did anyone forget they had them?	yes	no				

② **Did the shape of a meld ever matter?**

Melds now only decide how many cards you spend. Straight of four and quadruple do the same work. Did anyone care which they held — and did anyone build toward a bigger meld on purpose?

shape felt...	irrelevant	mildly	still interesting
anyone hold cards to build a big meld?	yes	no	

③ **The cost of matching the winner — and how often you cashed**

Match the winner's card count and lose, and one card you played is set aside for 1 gold and goes to the shared pile; the meld that ranked last takes 1 gold. Tally one mark per card **you** cashed instead of using on the map (the sim predicts about one in three). Count for yourself only.

cards cashed _____ of _____ played	·	did cashing ever feel like the <i>obvious</i> choice, with no decision in it?	yes / no
did anyone ask how many cards they could use?	yes	no	(the rule exists to stop that)
giving up a card for matching the winner felt...	a real cost	barely noticed	too harsh
did anyone play FEWER cards on purpose to dodge it?	yes	no	
the last-place coin felt...	welcome	pointless	like charity

④ **What ended the game, and did it land?**

The simulator says a suit's advanced deck always runs dry before anyone places a twentieth unit. If that happened, did the ending feel earned or abrupt?

ended because...	a suit ran out	someone placed 20 units	
the ending felt...	earned	abrupt	nobody noticed it coming

⑤ **Food and the coin shuffle**

Coins sit on your band's food slots and your people eat them at each recycle; you may move coins between reserve, food and fortifications freely on your turn.

did anyone starve (return units)?	yes, ___ times	never		
pre-placing food on the slots was...	clear	fiddly	forgotten	pointless
anyone pull coins off a fortification to eat?	yes	no		

Anything you had to look up, argue about, or invent

Best and worst moment

Scores — seat / total / population / victory row / dominance / gold left

would play again 1 2 3 4 5 · rules were clear 1 2 3 4 5

Blink · v0.23 · playtest sheet · Toby Siko · the longer feedback form covers everything this page does not